

Post-incident review PIR-2026-031

Data Warehouse: degraded latency

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 03 May 2026, Data Warehouse experienced degraded latency in production (US West) for about 25 minutes. A latency threshold alert fired for the service's main endpoint. Investigation found that the disk on the primary node filled with transaction logs.

Impact

Users of Data Warehouse saw degraded latency for about 25 minutes. The service owner, Data Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:13 First signal received.
- 09:31 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:43 Likely cause identified.
- 10:19 Mitigation applied.
- 10:47 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that the disk on the primary node filled with transaction logs.

The team first suspected a recent configuration change, but the change log showed nothing relevant.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Exercise the rollback path in staging as part of every release.
- Load test the service at twice the expected peak before the next campaign.
- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.